

Mobilizer Identification Tool

How High Performers Win
the Consensus-Based Sale

A Framework for Member Conversations

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REWRITING THE PLAYBOOK

How Do Hi-Pers Engage Customer Stakeholders?

Identifying Mobilizers



Customer Stakeholder Identification Toolkit

Activating Mobilizers



Customer-Paced Sales Funnel



SEC Commercial Coaching Toolkit

Appendix



Stakeholder
Targeting
Criteria



Detective
Workshops



Stakeholder
Initiated
Capabilities
Diagnostic



Deal Verification Toolkit
Solae™ **CAREMARK**®

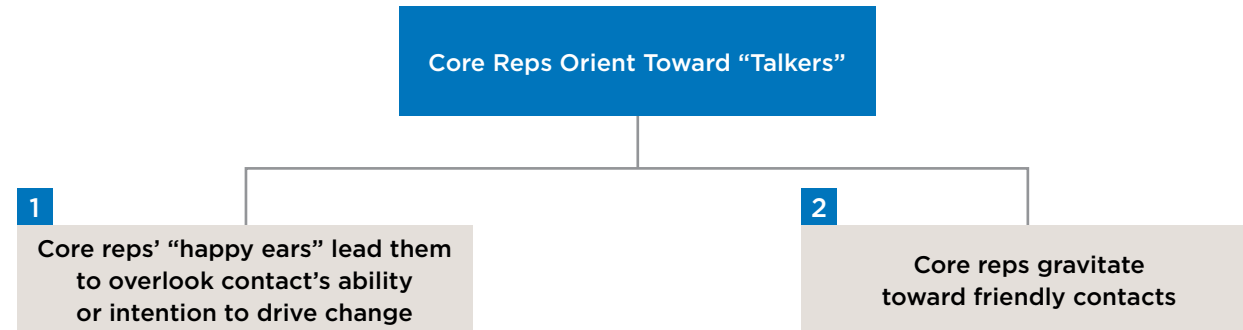


Core reps orient toward friendly contacts who look good on the surface, but ultimately can't drive the purchase decision.

- Inherent human traits draw core reps to safe, comfortable, conversations with people who provide positive validation.
- Customers similarly avoid tension, and therefore may appear more positive about the situation than they actually are.
- At best, picking the wrong contact means wasted time. At worst, it damages the supplier's credibility forever by linking them with a non-credible stakeholder.

OH, SWEET TALKER

Root Causes of Core Orientation Toward Talkers



"A lot of reps take whoever they can get. The problem is, if you let the wrong person carry your message, **you forever get lumped in with their bad ideas and cut off from influence. Having a bad contact is worse than nothing at all."**

Hi-Per Sales Rep
Facilities Services

Source: CEB analysis.

Teach core reps to think like hi-pers when determining true Mobilizer potential.

- Hi-pers abide by a skeptical “prove-it” mentality when working with customers. A detective-type mindset can help foster such a mentality.
- While the ability to read people may seem like pure art, hi-pers typically use a narrow set of relatively concrete “tells” to separate customers’ words from reality. These tells can be learned relatively quickly.

READ BETWEEN THE LINES

Solutions to Rep Misinterpretation of Mobilizer Potential

**Core reps’ “happy ears”
lead them to
overlook contact’s
ability or intention
to drive change**

**Foster a Skeptical
Mindset**



Detective Workshops
(Appendix)

**Core reps gravitate
toward friendly contacts**

**Teach Reps the Key
“Tells” of Mobilizers**



Stakeholder
Identification Toolkit

Source: CEB analysis.

Each type of Mobilizer has a clear set of strengths to leverage and deficiencies to compensate.

- The key differences between the three Mobilizers tends to lie on a rational versus emotional spectrum. Go-getters are very rational. Skeptics are also quite rational, with slightly more social intelligence. Teachers are highly emotional.
- Engage these individuals by leveraging their key strengths and compensating their weaknesses. Each profile has high-level guidance on how to approach each stakeholder.

GETTING TO KNOW YOU

Summary of the Three Mobilizer Profiles

"The Go-Getter"—Gets It Done



"Show us business value and we'll get 'er done."

Strengths

- Relentless
- Handles ambiguity well (creates structure)
- Team player

Deficiencies

- Less visionary
- Poor storyteller
- Values rational over emotional explanation

What to Do

- Prioritize organizational benefit
- Give them a vision and ensure they convey that vision

"The Teacher"—Sells the Vision



"I love this idea! Lets save the details for later."

Strengths

- Persuasive
- Advises others
- Passionate

Deficiencies

- Can be viewed as ungrounded
- Weak in project management
- Manages primarily through excitement

What to Do

- Stick with their vision—only tweak as needed
- Provide a clear project plan and timelines
- Keep them on track with interim deadlines

"The Skeptic"—Makes You Prove It



"I know how to get things done, but you've got a lot to prove..."

Strengths

- His buy-in means organization listens
- Prepares others for change
- Forces precision

Deficiencies

- Struggles with ambiguity
- Moves cautiously
- Communicates in plans, not ideas

What to Do

- Drive urgency to compel them to act
- Provide absolute certainty in the project plan
- Give them a compelling story to share

n = 717.

Source: CEB analysis.

Get what you can from Talkers, but don't rely on them to drive a purchase forward.

- Engage Guides, Friends, and Climbers cautiously. While potentially helpful, they can occupy precious time—or worse, damage your credibility, if you become associated with someone who's uncredible or untrusted.
- The Guide is easy to confuse with the Teacher; the key tell is that the Guide won't typically follow-up on promises that require them to take action.
- The Climber is easy to confuse with the Go-Getter, since both are ambitious and driven; the key tell is that the Climber spends most of the conversation talking about personal motivation instead of what's good for the organization. They are often less credible in peers' eyes.

BEWARE OF SWEET TALKERS

Summary of "Talker" Profiles and What to Do with Each

"The Guide"—Tells You Everything



"Here's what you need to know about us..."

Strengths

- Knows the organization
- Helpful
- Candid

Deficiencies

- Not action-oriented
- Less influence
- Is likely helping other vendors

What to Do

- Pull as much information from them as you can
- Don't mistreat as a Mobilizer—they won't get things done

"The Friend"—Likes to Hang Out



"Sure, I'll take a call—what new things can you show me?"

Strengths

- Gives you time
- Sets up meetings with others

Deficiencies

- Rarely buys—but still takes your call
- Their "help" isn't always valuable
- Is likely helping other vendors

What to Do

- Don't get too comfortable with them—they can become a red herring and a time-sink

"The Climber"—Out for Themselves



"What's in it for me?"

Strengths

- Ambitious and driven
- Savvy—knows how to get what they want

Deficiencies

- Distrusted—others assume they have an agenda
- Backs out at the first sign of risk to themselves

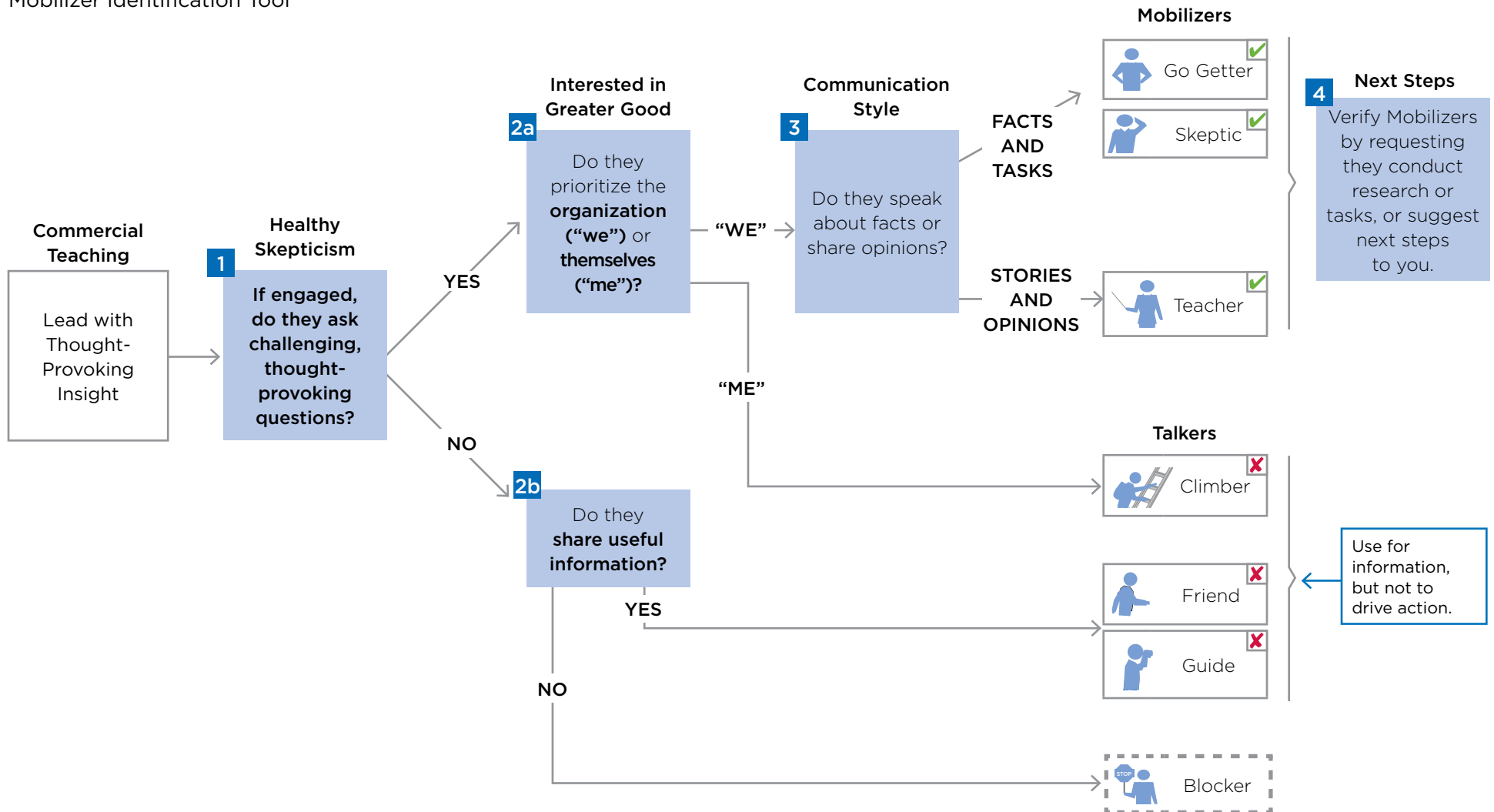
What to Do

- Focus on the personal win if you think you need them
- Be careful—their help can backfire if you become linked with a distrusted contact's personal agenda

Source: CEB analysis.

PROGRESSIVELY DISQUALIFY

Mobilizer Identification Tool



Source: CEB analysis.

MAKING THE TELLS EXPLICIT

Mobilizer Confirmation Worksheet and Coaching Guide
Training and Coaching Tool to Help Reps Recognize the Signs of Mobilizer Potential

Screen	How to Test Them	What to Look For	
1 Healthy Skepticism They challenge you and want you to challenge them. Key tell: They ask difficult questions and push back on new ideas. Be careful not to get carried away with overly ambitious ideas—Mobilizers want to accomplish things.	A - Share information they haven't heard before (e.g., a problem they were thinking about in the wrong way). - Propose a slightly aggressive vision that extends beyond their span of control—do they latch on, or back you down? - Proactively bring up risks of changing the status quo - Suggest that change may not be good—can they convince you otherwise? - Ask if anything in your proposal needs to change to make it work	Yes - Intrigued: Receptive to and engages with new ideas - Thoughtful: Seeks to understand (e.g. “Here’s how we’re a little different; how do you think this applies?”) - Explorative: They probe, even disagree, to test the merit of an idea, offer alternative points of view, or interrupt - Risk-Conscious: They think out loud about how to address risks	No - Quick-to-Agree: They go along with everything you say - Rejection: They are defensive or dismissive (e.g., “yeah but we’re different”; “we just don’t feel that pain”) - Overconfidence: They want to jump immediately to execution - Risk-averse: They balk at the first sign of risk
2a Interested in Greater Good Their motivation is to improve the business, not a personal agenda Key tell: They talk about their organization and team more than themselves (and not just complaining). Be careful to look beyond what they say to accurately place their motivations.	- Ask about a recent successful (or unsuccessful) initiative - Ask about their past jobs and career aspirations - Ask what else they are working on besides their core job - Ask about recent networking or conference they attended to get ideas for their organization.	We “We” language: They speak to the greater good of the team - They volunteer for additional projects or leadership positions outside their day job - They give peers credit and speak with candor about their own mistakes	Me “Me” language: They bring discussions back to themselves - They claim they can do more than their rank or function suggest - They criticize others’ work and blame others for past mistakes
3 Communication Style Determine whether they convey thoughts more rationally or emotionally. Key tell: Do they talk about facts and tasks, or share opinions and stories? Be careful to focus on the broader context of your conversation—most people convey thoughts both rationally and emotionally at different times.	- Ask how they would approach others in their organization on the subject - Ask what they are trying to accomplish - Ask how they would make the case for change - Ask them about specific details or data points	Facts and Tasks - Speak in terms of numbers, metrics, and results - Dive straight into business discussions - Stick to the facts, often citing evidence - Focus on the objective and next steps - They think out loud about next steps - Speak directly and succinctly - Rely on presentations or charts of their own	Opinions and Stories - Speak in stories and anecdotes - Express strong opinions and hyperbole - Talk about the vision - Energetic and excitable; show a range of vocal inflection and tone - Use hand gestures extensively
4 Next Steps: Follow-up request to test potential Mobilizers commitment and influence			
B Commitment Exercise: Customer to do: Find out who else is impacted by the problem Rep will do: Send examples of how the problem has manifested at other companies What you’re looking for: Did they do it? If they report back with the information, you know they are committed; if they’ve done nothing, they likely aren't a Mobilizer.	C Influence Exercise: Customer to do: Arrange for rep to meet with key stakeholders Rep will do: Connect the contact with relevant outside experts What you’re looking for: Who showed up? If most of the people they invite show up, the contact has influence and political power; if multiple people no-show, the contact lacks influence.		

Source: CEB analysis.

- What this tool is used for:** Quickly excluding Non-Mobilizers and categorizing promising contacts to determine how to coach them.
- How we created this tool:** SEC surveyed 717 customers, and conducted structured interviews with high-performing sales reps from 12 industries to determine ideal contact characteristics and methods for identifying them. All content in the tool comes directly from customer analysis and high-performer interviews.
- How reps use this tool:**
 - During a call, test the contact and look for the reactions in the tool.
 - If the contact displays promise, propose one of the two follow-ups at bottom to confirm the contact’s seriousness and influence.
 - Be sure to verify by asking other stakeholders’ of their impressions.
- How managers use this tool to coach:**
 - Conduct deal-level coaching on whether reps’ contacts are Mobilizers by asking reps which signs they have seen.
 - If the rep is not sure or you are suspicious, have the rep schedule time with the customers and perform the tests listed in the second column.